

Troubleshooting Log - March 24, 2026

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Issue 1

Symptom:

- Seed and API connectivity problems against external Render Postgres.

Root cause:

- External Postgres connection required SSL/TLS.

Resolution:

- Updated backend DB connection logic to auto-enable SSL for render.com hosts or DB_SSL=true.

Verification:

- Seed scripts completed successfully.
- API health endpoint responded with status ok.

Issue 2

Symptom:

- API endpoint sometimes showed empty results in deployed environment.

Root cause:

- Service/branch/database configuration mismatch during deployment iterations.

Resolution:

- Standardized deployment to service wp-archive-api-2 and corrected environment setup.
- Re-seeded data in target database.

Verification:

- /api/items returned populated JSON with total 9 items.

Issue 3

Symptom:

- Frontend loaded then went blank.
- Browser console error: rating.toFixed is not a function.

Root cause:

- Rating values arrived as strings from API/database, but frontend called toFixed directly.

Resolution:

- Wrapped rating rendering with Number(...) conversion in:
 - frontend/src/components/ItemCard.jsx
 - frontend/src/components/Sidebar.jsx

Verification:

- UI renders correctly with ratings and no crash.

Notes

- Browser warning about forced layout during stylesheet load is non-blocking and unrelated to the crash.